YANGXU LIN

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FIELDS OF INTEREST

Primary: Labour Economics, Applied Microeconomics, Development Economics,
Secondary: Household Economics, Public Economics, Health Policy, Education Policy

EDUCATION

MSc in Economics for Development, University of Oxford 2023 – 2024

Grade: 69%, Merit

Core Papers: Macroeconomics and International Trade (72%, Distinction, highest mark in the cohort), Quantitative Methods (73%, Distinction).

MicroMasters, Data, Economics, and Design of Policy, MIT (via MITx Online) 2022 – 2023

Grade: average 94%, A

Core Courses: Microeconomics (96%), Data Analysis for Social Scientists (94%), Designing and Running Randomised Evaluations (91%), Advanced Development Economics (97%).

BSc in Economics, University of Liverpool + Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University 2017 – 2021

Grade: average 86%, UK grading system, First-class hons (≥70%)

Prize: Best Overall Academic Performance in BSc Economics

Rank: **1st** for all four years 2017-18, 2018-19, 2019-20 and 2020-21.

Core Papers: Multivariate Calculus (97%), Mathematics for Economics (89%), Statistics (88%), Linear Algebra for Mathematical Science (86%), Advanced Metrics (83%), Microeconomics I-II (92% & 88%), Advanced Macroeconomics (88%), Game Theory (72%), Experimental Economics & Finance (96%), International Trade (96%), Monetary Economics (93%).

Standardised test scores 2025:

GRE: Verbal 162, Quant 167, Analytical Writing 5.0; Duolingo English: 145/160 (writing 160/160)

JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS

Lin, Y., Adesina, O., Asuma, B. S., Chen-Charles, J., Chalasani, S., Cluver, L., Diop, R. A., Rudgard, W. E. (2026) "Community health workers and adolescent health and well-being across sub-Saharan Africa: A systematic review and meta-analysis." *Journal of Adolescent Health*. [Link]

ACADEMIC WORK IN PROGRESS

"Where Do Robots Create Skilled Jobs? Evidence from European Talent Flows" (with Dr Dequn Teng)

Matching industrial robot data to worker-level hiring flows from online professional profiles for 24 European countries and 9 sectors (2008-2022), and instrumenting robot adoption with adoption elsewhere, we find that robots increase skilled hiring in Central and Eastern European near-shore economies but not in Western Europe.

"Climate Change and Child Time-Use: Evidence from Ethiopia" (MSc dissertation revision)

Using Young Lives panel data from Ethiopia, I first estimate the effects of contemporaneous environmental shocks on children's time-use, including schooling and work, instrumenting self-reported shocks with a leave-one-out community

measure, and trace how these effects evolve over time with an event-study design. I then use newly matched climate data to study how early-childhood climate exposure (temperature and rainfall) shapes children's time-use a decade later.

"Estimating Returns and Costs of Scaling Up Adolescent-Targeted Multi-Component Interventions in Ethiopia" (with Dr William Rudgard, Professor Chris Desmond, Professor Lucie Cluver, et al.)

We estimate the costs and economic returns of scaling up a multi-sector programme for adolescent girls in Ethiopia. Interventions include community norm dialogues, girls' clubs, accelerated learning for out-of-school girls and institutional strengthening, which aims to raise schooling and reduce child marriage and adolescent pregnancy.

"The effect of climate-related anticipatory cash transfers on household food security and child nutrition in LMICs: a systematic review" (with Diana Mwala and Professor Lucie Cluver)

Anticipatory cash transfers release social protection payments before a forecast climate shock, such as a flood or drought, rather than after it, so that households could avoid costly coping strategies. Despite a growing number of field experiments, this evidence has not been synthesised. We systematically review its effects on household food security and child nutrition in LMICs, and what they reveal about the value of acting before rather than after a shock.

POLICY DOCUMENT PUBLICATIONS

Harnessing Community Health Workers to Improve Adolescent Health and Well-being in Africa. UNICEF, 2025 (with Dr William Rudgard [Oxford], Professor Lucie Cluver [Oxford], Dr Satvika Chalasani [UNICEF], et al.)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Economic Evaluation Research Team, Dep. of Social Policy and Intervention (DSPI), University of Oxford
2024 – present

Research focus: Applied Microeconomics, Development Economics, Human Capital

Supervisors: Professor Lucie Cluver, Dr. William Rudgard

- **Experimental research and human capital:** Co-investigator on a field experiment in Northern Nigeria examining adolescents' human-capital transitions. Work closely with trial leads on a cluster-randomised controlled trial evaluating a multi-component intervention to improve secondary school transition, learning outcomes and non-cognitive skills. Contribute to grant development, survey instrument design (including measures of cognitive and non-cognitive skills), ethics applications, and the pre-analysis plan (in progress).
- **Economic evaluation of public investment to end child marriage:**
  - **Ethiopia:** Lead economic analyst developing a flexible, interactive, dynamic scale-up costing and cost-effectiveness tool for scaling-up child-marriage prevention interventions, integrating primary data from the *Act With Her* RCT and the Luminos structured pedagogy programme. The tool enables users to select target regions and coverage, model alternative rollout trajectories and conduct sensitivity and scenario analyses on how intervention design, geographic scale, implementation arrangements and state capacity change resource requirements, costs and cost-effectiveness at scale. Second author of the accompanying economic evaluation study (in progress). Software: R, advanced Excel.
  - **Northern Nigeria:** Contributed to cost-effectiveness analysis using data from the Centre for Girls' Education *Pathways to Choice* RCT and co-authoring the accompanying economic evaluation study (in progress).

- **Evidence synthesis:** First author of a systematic review and meta-analysis of community health worker interventions and adolescent health, published in the Journal of Adolescent Health (2026). Software: R, Python.
- **Teaching curriculum development:** Co-developed research-informed lecture materials on child poverty and inequality for the University of Bristol and the University of Oxford.
- **Research seminar:** Co-organised a departmental seminar series in Michaelmas 2026.
- **Policy engagement:** Collaborate with UNICEF and African government ministries through the Accelerate Research Hub.

Intern Economist, R-Health Consult 2023

- Worked on a WHO road safety investment case for Tunisia, under the supervision of a senior WHO health economist, applying WHO's standard investment case methodology to five evidence-based road safety interventions. Modelled the health burden (road traffic injuries and fatalities) and associated economic burden, and projected the health and economic benefits of each intervention. Costed intervention implementation and computed return-on-investment estimates to inform intervention prioritisation. Led the draft of economic modelling and return-on-investment sections of the investment case report.

United Nations Volunteer, UNDP, Turkey — HIV, Health and Development Unit 2023

- Technical support for a health tax investment case on sugar-sweetened beverage tax in Thailand. Economic modelling and health impact assessment of alternative tax scenarios on consumption, non-communicable disease outcomes, healthcare expenditure and government revenue.

OTHER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Part-time Associate, Healthcare Consulting, ZS Associates, Shanghai 2022
Social Intelligence & Analytics Intern, Ipsos, Shanghai 2022
Investment Banking Intern, China Securities, Beijing 2021

HONOURS, SCHOLARSHIPS AND GRANTS

Grants

St Hugh's College, Oxford — Alumni Grant Fund for research on labour market in Africa ($500 + $250 travel) 2024
St Hugh's College, Oxford — Barbinder Watson Fund for conference travel ($250) 2024

Scholarships

First-Class Scholarship for Academic Excellence, rank 1st, BSc Economics (RMB 10,000) 2020
First-Class Scholarship for Academic Excellence, rank 1st, BSc Economics (RMB 10,000) 2019
First-Class Scholarship for Academic Excellence, rank 1st (RMB 10,000) 2018

Prizes & Awards

Prize for Best Overall Academic Performance in BSc Economics, International Business School Suzhou, XJTLU 2021
Merit-Based Outstanding Student, Bureau of Education, Jiangsu Province, China 2018

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee

Reviewer, *Journal of Adolescent Health* 2026 – present

Presentations

Presenter, Centre for Evidence-Based Interventions, DSPI, University of Oxford 2025
Presenter, Accelerate Research Hub Research-in-Progress, University of Oxford and University of Cape Town 2025
Head Country Delegate of Bangladesh, Model WTO Conference on Subsidies and Environment, WTO and University of St. Gallen 2024
Delegate of Brunei Economy, Model APEC Conference on MSMEs in the Digital Era, APECT 2018

Voluntary Service

London Ambassador, MIT Alumni Startup (exp.) 2027
Mentor, Refugee-Led Research Hub, University of Oxford 2024 – 2025
Volunteer, Changcheng Love Camp, Weihai City, China 2017 – 2021
Member, Enactus World, XJTLU 2017 – 2018

SKILLS

Software: Python, Stata, R, Matlab, Excel, LaTeX, SurveyCTO, NVivo
Languages: English (proficient), Chinese (native)